

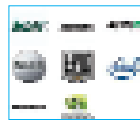
Indian Overclocker Beats World

Mumbai-based Harshal Tank hit the world's highest 8800 GT 512 MB 3DMark 06 score in Taiwan this February. He runs an Intel Core 2 Extreme 9650 processor with a dry ice-cooling solution, on the soon-to-be-launched Gigabyte GA-X48T-DQ6 motherboard.



Alliance Will Promote PC As A Gaming Platform

The newly formed PC Gaming Alliance, aims to create a common platform for hardware and software creators, developers, publishers and others committed to PC gaming. This alliance comprises both software and hardware giants such as Intel, Microsoft, AMD and Dell, among others.



Enter



Nick Desai
CEO, Juice Wireless

Nick Desai, CEO, Juice Wireless recently visited India to launch JuiceCaster. Primarily targeted at mobile users, users can upload, download and share rich media content using JuiceCaster.

What makes JuiceCaster different from other online photo/video service providers?

JuiceCaster aims to provide seamless and synchronous connectivity over any platform. It is available as JuiceCaster Player and is embeddable on social networking avenues such as MySpace, Facebook, Hi5 and many others in addition to Web sites and blogs. JuiceCaster Mobile application (native) and JuiceCaster WAP are available for phones with WAP 2.0 browsers. Also, we've launched JuiceCaster D for desktop, which completes the seamless circle of sharing rich media content.

How is JuiceCaster going to be accessible to the common Indian man?

With camera phone prices gradually dropping, India already has a large number of mobile phone subscribers. It is indeed a potential market for us. We're in talks with various cellular operators in India for making the JuiceCaster Player for mobiles and its services available by the Q3 of 2008. Individuals carrying camera phones with active Internet data connectivity can capture images/videos to upload, and share them straight away with others *without* the need of a PC.

What comprises your target audience in India?

Initially, in India, JuiceCaster will be targeting the young, peppy, tech-crazy and those up-to-date with IT. Specifically, people between the age group of 18 to 35 years would be our target audience. As per our research, we'll also target people from other age groups, since they too are avid users involved in the social networking phenomenon.

IT'S OVER!

Toshiba Gives Up On HD-DVD

The greatest war for the next-generation video format has finally come to an end—Toshiba's pulled the plug on its war with Sony's Blu-Ray. According to latest reports, Toshiba has formally announced that it would not be continuing its HD-DVD business. This race was definitely fiercer than the earlier video battle over Betamax and VHS. This time, it was companies that were deciding what the consumer gets and not the other way round! With companies such as Sony and Toshiba pitted against each other, it was stiff competition all the way through. For Sony, it was a matter of prestige to win this battle, as it had already lost with Betamax to JVC in the VHS days.

On one side was the Blu-Ray consortium led by Sony, with Apple, Dell, HP, Sharp, Philips, Panasonic, Hitachi and eight other companies on Blu-Ray's board of directors. On the other hand, the HD-DVD front was led by Toshiba, followed by Sanyo, NEC and Memory Tech. This time, however, the battle was prolonged, and there was a host of factors that decided the outcome. The most significant decisive factor,

however, was the gaming industry. Microsoft, the makers of the Xbox 360 has been a strong supporter of the HD-DVD standard. In contrast, Sony—the makers of the PlayStation 3—have

significant of them was Time Warner, which switched totally from HD-DVD to Blu-Ray, leaving Sony with a virtual monopoly in the DVD format arena. So where does Toshiba go from here?

And what about Sony?

The latest news says that Sony is in talks with Toshiba to sell its PS3 chip manufacturing plant for an amount to supposedly in excess of \$ 858 million. Both Toshiba and Sony Corporation, have reportedly partnered with Sony Computer Electronic Inc. (SCEI) for the production of high-performance semiconductors. The whole DVD fiasco doesn't seem to have ended on a bitter note after all...

Most technological developments and gadgets enter Indian shores after they have been tried and tested in Europe and the Americas. For example, the iPhone has not yet been launched in India—the average Indian consumer normally complains about this fact. However, this time round we should be thankful for the late entry of the high-definition DVD battle into India—actually it hasn't got here yet! Overall, Indian consumers



Illustration Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

understandably supported the Blu-Ray format. As a result, the soaring sales of gaming applications have yielded a significant rise in the sales of Blu-Ray discs. With half the battle won in the gaming industry, the remaining half of the battle was decided by Hollywood. Till recently, Universal and Paramount Studios were the only Hollywood studios to back HD-DVDs—the majority had backed Blu-Ray. The most

Security Watch

Adobe Reader might be infected

The Problem

According to iDefense Labs, in January banner ads have actively been delivering malicious files, and Adobe's Reader and Acrobat services might have been the prime target of malicious code.

Symantec's security experts have commented that the banners might've redirected the users to potentially harmful Web sites by these files. On opening these files, the Zonebac trojan gets installed on to the system. This trojan, then disables the system's antivirus software and downloads additional malware. So banner ads can be dangerous, since the hacker might've corrupted them with malicious code by exploiting Adobe's Flash technology.

The Solution

Adobe has issued patches by addressing the vulnerabilities as critical. Update to version 8.1.2 to prevent any malicious code from adversely affecting them. The update is available at <http://tinyurl.com/28z9qs>. Avoid clicking banner ads and do not open any PDF documents if you're not sure about its authenticity.

have not been significantly affected by all the hue and cry among the Blu-Ray and HD-DVD camps. The average Indian consumer, till now has been happy with the normal DVD format. With significant certainty, now emerging in the DVD arena, Indians can now decide purely by the deals they get!

COME...PLAY

PS3 To Lead In 2008

The gaming industry had witnessed phenomenal growth last year, with major players such as Nintendo, Sony and Microsoft posting massive sales figures. According to research firm iSuppli, the PS3 will pose the strongest growth figures among all video game consoles. The projected worldwide sales figures this year are 10 million units for PS3, 12.2 million units for the Wii, and 7.5 million units for the Xbox 360.

With strong sales, lower prices and broader appeal among audiences, the Wii

is all poised to be the market leader with a global installation base of 30.2 million units. On the other hand, the Xbox 360 has struggled in Japan and Europe, where the Sony brand formerly dominated, and is on course to increase its user base to 25.7 million units by the end of 2008.

In the light of all conditions, the PS3, which lagged due to its price and lack of blockbuster games for most of last year, would double its installation base to 20.3 million users and by 2011 will be the industry leader.

In India, however, the Xbox 360 leads in terms of market share. However, with Blu-Ray getting the upper hand in terms of being the preferred DVD format, Sony has a lot to gain. What happens to Xbox 360 users who use HD-DVD drives with their gaming consoles is still to be seen. The users hit the most, are those who bought external HD-DVD drives for their Xbox 360s. How Microsoft compensates them, is a matter of concern and will be closely watched in the forthcoming days.

HOT Toshiba
For being a sport, and finally surrendering to the more powerful forces that drove Blu-ray to supremacy. They're even collaborating with arch-rival Sony to manufacture NAND Flash memory! Talk about an amicable truce...

NOT Toshiba
For promising the world with the HD-DVD format, selling the players really cheap, getting over 750,000 people to buy them, outselling Blu-ray units for a while, and then calling it quits! We can hear the early adopters' screaming even from here!

WHAT YOU MISSED

MS, Yahoo, And Them

The world is going abuzz with talks between the two east-coast companies—Yahoo from Sunnyvale, California and Microsoft from Redmond, Washington. Surprisingly, Google was

Which type of Web application do you use the most besides mail and chat??

(You, too, can participate in this poll—at www.thinkdigit.com)

- ☐ A File Storage
☐ C Massively Multiplayer Online Games

- ☐ B Multimedia streaming streaming (Video and audio)
☐ D Blogging, wikis, discussion forums

Option D. I get a chance to express my views and the whole world could be my stage; they also give me a chance to be introduced to a rare and endangered species—the practical intellectual.

Bijoy Yohanan
Bangalore



Option D. The objective behind the creation of Internet was information sharing, wasn't it? With a medium like this, we know and read different paradigms and perspectives.

Nidheesh P.K.
Mumbai



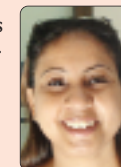
Option B is what I'd like to choose. At work, I listen to streaming music to relax. In my free time, I watch lot of instructional and tutorial-based videos online.

Amit Shah
Mumbai



I'll go for option D because knowledge sharing and public views on various subjects are obtained. I enjoy online debates by veterans as well as freshers on any topic.

Sharlet Macwan
Mumbai



I choose D. Visiting forums and wikis help me troubleshooting at my work. Also, through interaction with other people at these places, I can broaden my knowledge.

Dhaval Pancholi
Baroda



I choose option B since I spend lot of time watching online videos and listening to music. Of course it is better than reading irrelevant discussions at some websites. I listen to the latest music on streaming sites or radio stations.

Parin Sutaria
Baroda



(You, too, can participate in this poll—at www.thinkdigit.com)